



GOOD THINGS HAPPEN

Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church

We seek, we serve, we celebrate.

January

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Good Things Happen
is the newsletter of
Minnehaha United Methodist Church,
published each month.

**The deadline for February is
January 17**

Contributions may be brought to the
office or emailed to:
office@minnehaha.org
**3701 East 50th Street
Minneapolis, MN 55417**

About Us:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church is a thriving multi-generational, multicultural Christian community devoted to social justice and personal spiritual growth. The congregation is both mission- and worship-focused. In addition to its worship, education, and social activities, the church supports local mission activities, including a food shelf and a monthly food distribution program. The church also supports a variety of national and international relief, education, and development projects.

A Reconciling Congregation:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church opens our doors to all God's people. We will strive to offer unconditional love and acceptance to all persons, regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history. We work to eliminate prejudice and discriminatory practices within ourselves and within our community. -adopted 2006

Our Mission:

We seek, we serve, we celebrate, we carry our Christian faith into our community and the world. We provide a caring gathering place to worship God and to grow spiritually. -reconfirmed 2011

January



SUNDAY WORSHIP

9:00 am Worship with organ and choir.

10:00 am Education and Fellowship

11:00 am Worship with band and vocals.

Infant and toddler care available all morning.

Minnehaha Happenings in January

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
1 New Year's Day Communion 10a New Year's Worship 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA 7p Venturing Crew	2 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2p Brighter Minds Music 6p UMW Leadership Potluck	3 9a Fun & Fitness Group 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Toastmasters (Taleweavers)	4 10a Staff Meeting 1p Minnehaha circle 4p Methodicals 6:30p Finance 6:45p Chancel Choir 7p Children's Council	5 9a Food Shelf Board 9a Fun & Fitness Group 9a Minnehaha Play-date 9:30a Brighter Minds Music	6 Epiphany 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a Al-Anon 6:30p RCA	7 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
8 UMW Sunday 9a Worship with Organ & Choir 10a Education & Fellowship 11a Worship with Band 4p Youth Council 6p Youth Night (grades 6-12) 7p Pack 1 Plan. 7p SAA	9 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1 6:30p Cub Scouts	10 Food Shelf Dinner Prep 9a Fun & Fitness Group 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Church Council	11 9:30a Nokomis Circle 4p Methodicals 5p Food Shelf Dinner 6:45p Chancel Choir	12 9a Fun & Fitness Group 9a Minnehaha Play-date 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 1p Communion @ Nokomis Sq 6p Mandala	13 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a Al-Anon 6:30p RCA 7p Fellowship Hall reserved 7p Taizé	14 8:30a Nokomis Neighborhood Group 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
15 9a Worship with Organ & Choir 10a Education & Fellowship 11a Worship with Band 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA 7p Venturing Crew	16 Martin Luther King 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1 6:30p Women's Soul Group	17 9a Fun & Fitness Group 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Toastmasters 6:30p Worship Committee	18 4p Methodicals 6:45p Chancel Choir	19 9a Fun & Fitness Group 9a Minnehaha Play-date 9:30a Brighter Minds Music	20 Inauguration Day Newsletter items due 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a Al-Anon 6:30p RCA	21 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
22 9a Worship with Organ & Choir 10a Education & Fellowship 11a Worship with Band 1p Annual Meeting 6p Youth & Confirmation Classes 7p SAA	23 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1 6:30p Cub Scouts 6:30p The New New Testament	24 9a Fun & Fitness Group 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 7p SPR	25 4p Methodicals 6:45p Chancel Choir	26 9a Fun & Fitness Group 9a Minnehaha Play-date 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10:30a The New New Testament 6:30p Trustees & B+G	27 Winter Retreat 9a Newsletter Collation 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a Al-Anon 6:30p RCA	28 Winter Retreat 7a MinneHarvest 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
29 Winter Retreat 9a Worship with Organ & Choir 10a Education & Fellowship 11a Worship with Band 2p Brighter Minds Recitals 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA	30 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1 6:30p The New New Testament	31 9a Fun & Fitness Group 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Toastmasters	Notes: Calendar may change without notice. Please contact Heather in the office before scheduling any events!			

Worship in January

A lot of different things are happening in worship in January! Don't forget that we begin the year with our New Year's Resolutions at one service at 10:00 on Jan. 1. The United Methodist Women will highlight their work of compassion and justice on Jan. 8, and we'll be interweaving the words of Martin Luther King, Jr. in worship on Jan. 15. Then, on Jan. 22, we start our new series on the New New Testament. Yes, that's right, New New. Lots of discoveries have been made over the years, and we know of lots of books and letters that were considered for inclusion in the New Testament of our Bible, but were ultimately rejected. A council convened by scholar Hal Taussig chose 10 that they would add today if they could, and we are going to look at 5 of those over the next five weeks. There will be an accompanying study on Monday evenings and Thursday mornings, so look for the article elsewhere for more information on attending that.

1st	"A New Covenant for a New Year"	Matthew 25:31-46
	<i>Communion</i> One Service at 10:00 am	
8th	United Methodist Women Sunday	Matthew 25:34-40
15th	"Letter From A Birmingham Jail"	I Corinthians 1:1-3
22nd	"A New New Testament: Thunder: Perfect Mind"	Thunder: Perfect Mind 1:1-5ab; 2:1-2; 4:3-6
29th	"A New New Testament: The Gospel of Mary"	Gospel of Mary 4:1-11; 6:1-4

Future Events at Minnehaha UMC—

Save the Date

- Jan. 1 – One service at 10:00
- Jan. 8 – United Methodist Women Sunday
- Jan. 11 – Food Shelf fundraising pasta dinner
- Jan. 22 – Infant Recognition
- Jan. 23 – New Monday evening Adult Study begins (on books that didn't make it into the New Testament)
- Jan. 26 – New Thursday morning Adult Study begins – same topic as Monday evening.
- Jan. 27-29 Winter Retreat at Camp Koronis
- Feb. 25 – My Changing Self workshop for children, youth, parents
- Feb. 25 — MinneHarvest
- Feb. 25 – My Changing Self workshop for children, youth, parents
- Feb. 26 – Camping Sunday
- Mar. 1 – Ash Wednesday (beginning of Lent)
- Mar. 4 – Auction
- Mar. 8 – Beginning of Lenten Study on prayer practices
- Mar. 12 – Daylight Savings begins (turn clocks ahead)
- Mar. 18 – Boy Scouts Pinewood Derby
- Mar. 25 -- MinneHarvest
- April 9 – Palm Sunday
- April 13 – Maundy Thursday (service at 7:00)
- April 14 – Good Friday (service at Richfield UMC at 7:00)
- April 16 – Easter! (services at 7, 9, 11)
- April 22 -- MinneHarvest



January Youth Events at Minnehaha UMC

- Jan. 1 New Years Day: One service at 10:00 am
No evening Confirmation classes
- Jan. 8 Youth night: Duct Tape Night in the Youth Room! For grades 6th-12th from 6-7:30pm we will participate in many different fun and entertaining team building games that all involve the use of Duct tape. There is no cost for this event.
- Jan. 15 No evening Confirmation classes – MLK Jr. Weekend
- Jan. 22 6:00-7:30: 6th-7th Grade in Youth Room, 8th-9th Confirmation in Wesley Room
- Jan 29 No evening classes—Winter Retreat



My Changing Self: Exploring Identity, Sexuality, and Spirituality

When: Saturday, February 25th, 2017 from 8:30am – 3:30pm

Who: Third through Eighth Graders from Lake Harriet, Richfield, and Minnehaha UMC

Where: Lake Harriet UMC, Minneapolis

Cost: \$20/child; \$30 family cap

What: A day to explore – in a safe and loving environment – who we are as individuals and how we live in relation to others. We'll discuss being made in God's image, looking at our changing bodies and how that impacts our interactions with others. We'll equip our young people with skills to filter messages received from peers and the media. We'll also provide them with resources, and work together to identify their support network. *My Changing Self* was designed to be repeated as children/ youth age – with different topics covered with different age groups.

Why: Navigating through adolescence is challenging for any child. Children and youth are inundated daily by messages about body image, sexuality, and a myriad of identity issues. We seek to provide them with a means to make their way through this stage of their lives, knowing that their bodies are their own. Too often, we divorce religion and spirituality from a healthy body image and relationships. *My Changing Self* will incorporate conversations about faith throughout the day. We'll celebrate who we are as part of God's creation, and empower students to make healthy decisions around body image, friendships, and sexuality.

How: We'll all gather at the same site, but will be broken into smaller groups by ages, and sometimes, by gender. All information will be presented in a developmentally appropriate way. Parents are invited to stay for an information session that will last until 10:30am. A resource table will be available as well to gather information to continue the conversation at home.



Children's Ministries

Happy New Year, All! I hope you had stayed warm over Christmas, and enjoyed some calm as well as crazy time together.

- As we head into 2017, there's a lot to look forward to at Minnehaha:
Registration is under way for the Minnehaha Retreat, and will soon be available for My Changing Self: Exploring Spirituality, Sexuality, and Identity.
- Child Care/Parent Night Outs are back with the first one on Saturday, January 7th - REGISTER NOW!
Wednesday Night Dinners and Programming will kick-off on January 18th with a Parent Workshop on "Parents, Kids, and Money Matters."
- The UMW Sponsored All-Church Play begins rehearsing on January 22nd.

Phew. We'll also be recognizing infants born into our congregation in 2016, begin planning for summer programs, be seeking out new adventure options for our Choose Your Own Adventure Days, and begin thinking about Children's Sunday. We're looking at more parent education opportunities, more opportunities for families to connect and, and always more ways to seek, serve, and celebrate as a community.

Keep your eyes out for information on all of the above and more. And, please let me know if you have any questions about any of it - we are always looking for ways to better take care of each other - and always love to have more thoughts and people involved in the process.

I hope to see you at one of the many events that start of our year, and look to 2017 with hope because of the amazing children and families we have in our community.

Hope, peace, love, and joy to all of you -

Jenia Strom

Director of Children & Family Ministries



*We hope you're having a wonderful and full Advent Season.
But, we imagine you might be ready for a break soon?*

Children's Council has your back:

Child Care & Parent's Night Out

When: Saturday, 7th January 2017 from 5-8pm

Where: Child Care Provided at Minnehaha UMC
Parents' are Invited to the Pow Home (just blocks from church) for an Evening Together

Cost:

\$25-1 child

\$35-2 children

\$40-3 children

For children up to 10 years of age

PLEASE RSVP BY JANUARY 1st

**Online Registration Available – Link at
www.minnehaha.org**

Or by calling Jenia at 612.721.6231



Minnehaha Playgroup

For Children 5 and Under & their Caregivers

Thursdays, from 9-11am

Stop in to play, talk, explore, support, and learn together. Feel free to bring snacks (no peanuts, please) if your child will need them. No RSVP necessary. All are welcome.

hosted by

Minnehaha United Methodist Church

When weather permits, we gather at local parks for playgroup. Otherwise, we meet at Minnehaha UMC, in the Childcare Room. If you'd like to join us on any given week, and want to know where to find us: join the "Minnehaha Playgroup" Facebook Page for weekly updates.



Highlights from the December 13, 2016 Church Council Meeting

TREASURER'S REPORT: The church remains current on its obligations to staff, vendors, contractors, apportionments and the inter-fund loan. As of November 30, we are on track to finish the year with a balanced budget. In addition, the mortgage for our 2010 building project should drop below \$400,000 by the end of the year. And our apportionments will be fully paid by the end of the year, giving us "forgiveness" from the Conference for unpaid apportionments four years ago. (Dennis Feller, Treasurer)

FOOD SHELF CONTRACT FOR 2017: Judy Durfey, Food Shelf Chair, presented an agreement between the Food Shelf and Minnehaha United Methodist Church for the upcoming year. The Food Shelf will continue to make a monthly payment of \$250 to the church to cover "common area maintenance," and (through the church) the Food Shelf will also pay the Food Shelf Coordinator's salary, FICA, Workers' Compensation and processing fees. The Council approved the agreement and it will be signed by representatives of Minnehaha UMC. (Judy Durfey, Food Shelf Chair)

PROCESS FOR REQUESTING MEMORIALS: Minnehaha UMC's Memorials Chair, Bev Kennedy, presented a document to the Council that outlines how Memorials (gifts generously given to the church upon someone's death) requests are handled. Each year committee chairs will present a "Wish List" of items not covered in the budget, such as furniture, a piano, a tree, special music, children's Bibles, and so on. The lists can be updated at any time during the year. If a family selects an item on a Wish List, the committee chair who submitted the list will be notified and then provide detailed information about the item, vendor and cost before the item is purchased. The Council approved the process. (Bev Kennedy, Memorials Chair)

HAVE YOU MADE YOUR 2017 STEWARDSHIP PLEDGE?: Pledges continue to come in for our 2017 "Imagine" campaign. Many people have increased their giving five and ten percent (and more!) over the previous year. If you haven't yet made a pledge, get a form from the office and drop it in the offering plate or mail it to the church. Your generous gifts will help us pay for staff, programs, activities, building maintenance, utilities and more. The 2017 budget for the church will be presented at the Annual Meeting and Church Conference on Sunday, January 22 at 1:00 PM. (Sue Claude, Finance Chair)

EVENT CLEAN-UP CHECKLIST STATUS: In order to keep rooms clean and reduce the amount of "extra" clean-up required of our custodian, we're putting together a pair of clean-up checklists—one for major events and the other for regular groups/activities. These cover basic things like putting the room back the way you found it, closing windows and turning off the lights. In addition, bigger events like the Harvest Dinner, Annual Bazaar and Halloween Carnival will pay a non-refundable fee to cover setup and cleanup. There will also be a direct point of contact for each group, instructions on dishwasher operation and the location of key cleaning tools and supplies. (Dean Ammerman, Council Chair)

"SEUSSICAL JR" MUSICAL: Rehearsals for the fantastical musical extravaganza "Seussical JR" begin January 22. Interested in being part of this production? Show up on Sunday, January 22 (probably at 5:00 PM; check with Maureen in case the time changes). The musical includes several of your favorite Dr. Seuss characters, including Horton the Elephant and the Cat in the Hat. (Maureen Trepp, Chair, United Methodist Women)

Continued from pg. 6

3 PARENTS' NIGHT OUT DATES: The church is planning Parents' Night Out dates for three Saturdays: January 7, March 4 and May 6. The money raised will be used for scholarships for our summer church camps. (Jenia Strom, Children's Ministries; Beth Minehart, Welcoming)

SUPPORT THE MINNEHAHA FOOD SHELF: You can support the Food Shelf in a lot of different ways. Place a donation in the offering plate using the envelope in the pews. Plan to come to the annual Pasta Dinner on January 11 from 5:00 to 7:00 PM (the Accordion Band will be there!). Thanks for helping your neighbors in need. (Judy Durfey, Food Shelf Chair)

NEXT MEETING JANUARY 10 AT 6:30 PM: The next Church Council meeting is scheduled for January 10 at 6:30 p.m. Everyone in the church is invited to attend. Complete minutes of the meeting are available on request.

—submitted by Dean Ammerman, Church Council Chair

Thanksgiving Offering

Thanks to everyone who contributed to Minnehaha and to our food ministries through the Thanksgiving offering. Through our Thanksgiving appeal, you generously contributed \$2,415 to the church and \$241.50 for our combined food ministries of the Food Shelf and MinneHarvest.

Food Ministries

MUMC supports **two food ministries**. MinneHarvest is a monthly free food giveaway, and our Food Shelf is a weekly food shelf for residents in our neighborhood, supported by us, Lake Nokomis Lutheran, and St. James Episcopal on the Parkway. Both of these ministries need regular financial support in order for them to continue to provide food to those in need. Please consider making a regular contribution to one or both of these ministries; you can use the handy envelopes provided in the pews, or you can write a check and indicate either MinneHarvest or Food Shelf on the memo line.

Books That Didn't Make the Bible

Scholars and archeologists have found a long list of book and letters that were considered for inclusion in the Bible but didn't make the cut, for some reason or another. Some we have just fragments of, and some we have in almost their entirety. In conjunction with the sermon series beginning January 22, we'll be studying five of those books over five weeks. Ones like the Gospel of Thomas and the Gospel of Mary you probably have heard of, but others, like Thunder: Perfect Mind and Odes of Solomon might be new to you. Whether you've read all of them or none of them, come to the study. You will want to read them in advance of each class (the books are fairly short, just a couple pages) along with an introduction from author and professor Hal Taussig, so either pick up a hard copy from Becky some Sunday, or email her and she will send out a scanned copy to you electronically. The same class will be offered each week on Monday evenings and Thursday mornings. Mondays, 6:30-7:30 January 23 – February 20 Thursday, 10-11 January 26 – February 23

Food Shelf Fundraiser



Pasta Dinner

donated by Fat Lorenzo's

Plus Door Prizes, Accordion Band & More!

Wednesday, January 11th
5:00 – 7:00 PM

Adults: \$10 | Ages 13-17: \$8 | Ages 12 & Under: Free

MINNEHAHA UNITED METHODIST CHURCH
3701 East 50th St., Mpls • www.minnehaha.org

Annual Meeting

Our Annual Meeting (otherwise known as a Church Conference) will be held on Sunday, January 22, 2017 at 1:00 in the afternoon at the church. The Superbowl is another two weeks away, but we'll be thinking football anyway, and you might even get a chance to create your own fantasy team. We'll also approve the real slate of officers for the new year and pass our 2017 budget. Wear a football jersey if you have one, but only nerf footballs, please. ☺

Budget Update

First of all, thanks to everyone who has gotten their pledges in, and to all of you for your generosity and your robust imaginations! At the time of the deadline for the newsletter, pledges are still coming in for our 2017 budget year, but things are looking good. We don't have quite as many pledges as we did total for last year, but many of you were able to meet the challenge of raising your pledges, and so we are on our way to being able to bring back the cuts we had to make last year and maybe even do a little expanding of our imaginations. The budget will be discussed broadly at our Tuesday, Jan. 10 Church Council meeting and then will be presented at our Annual Meeting on Sunday, January 22 at 1:00. Anyone is welcome to come to a Church Council meeting, and all members are voting members of our Annual Meeting (see article elsewhere about the Annual Meeting).

If you haven't turned in your pledge card yet, please do so right away!

Monthly Communion at Nokomis Square

On the second Thursday of the month at 1:00 p.m., Becky offers a brief communion service at Nokomis Square preceded by a conversation/study on some topic of interest. Anyone is welcome to come. This month we will be gathering on January 12.



**United
Methodist
Women**

United Methodist Women

- Thank you to those who helped serve at Simpson Shelter on Dec. 16 along with Margaret Rawson and Karen Davidson who helped prepare the meal. Servers include: Margaret Rawson, Kitty Campbell, Kim and Guy Saffeld, Jenny and Kirsten Ammerman, Ruel, Dave Noren, and Maureen Trepp. We will be serving again in March.
- MUMW is proud to be doing the Jan. 8 worship services. Please attend and learn who will receive our 2017 service awards.
- Join a fun group of actors: the Minnehaha Players and be in our annual all-church, all-ages musical. We will be presenting "Seussical Jr." on Feb. 24-26 in three performances. We will begin rehearsal on Sun. Jan. 22 at 5:00 and will have rehearsals on Sundays, Monday, Tuesday and Thursday evenings, from 6:30-8:30 (unless folks can come earlier). You don't need to attend every rehearsal but the last week, it would be good to have you there. Please contact Maureen Trepp at maureen-trepp@yahoo.com or 612-387-2520 if you are interested in joining us. This is a musical so there will be some singing for all. Costumers and set makers are needed, also.



Registration

Name(s) and age(s) of those attending: _____

Address: _____

Phone Number: _____

Email: _____

Dietary Restrictions: _____

Carpools will be arranged.

- ☐ I am able and willing to drive, I have room for _____
- ☐ I need a ride to the retreat.

Pricing information is listed on the backside of this form.

Please complete it and submit to the office.

Alternately, you can register online at:

<https://form.jotform.com/Minnehaha/minnehaha-winter-retreat-2017>

What will we do there?

Outdoor Activities

Broomball
Ice Skating
Cross country ski trails
Bonfire

Gym Activities

Basketball
Volleyball
Ping Pong
Carpet Ball
Air Hockey

Social Activities

Cards
Jigsaw Puzzles
Singing
Joking
Hanging Out
Skit Night

Learning Activities

Programming for adults, youth, and children

Worship on Sunday morning

No cooking; no washing dishes, no housework. Personal hygiene is optional.

Still have questions?

Talk to Paul Minehart, Joe Schlosser, David Graham, Jenia Strom, Leilani Thompson, or Becky Sechrist.

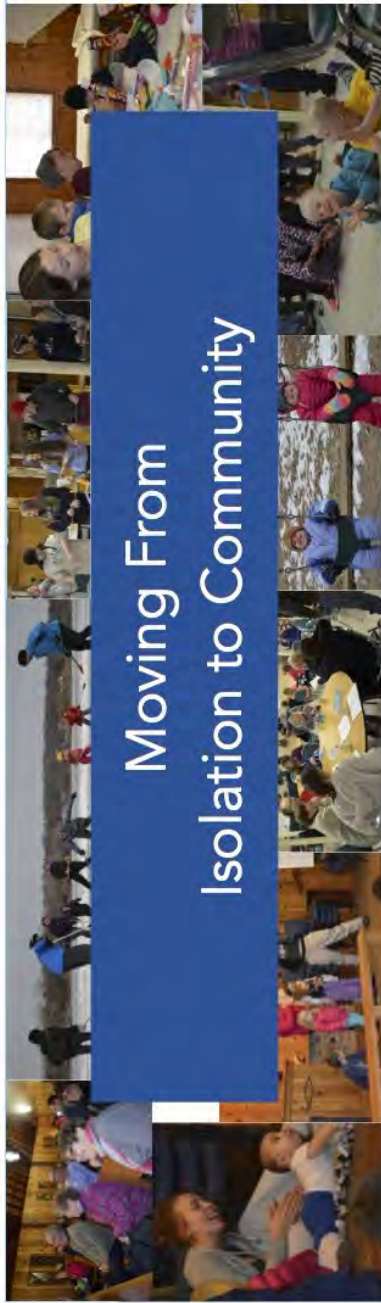
Join us for ...



Minnehaha's Winter Retreat



Jan. 27th-29th, 2017
at Lake Koronis
Assembly Grounds



Moving From Isolation to Community

Each year, people from Minnehaha UMC travel north to Lake Koronis Assembly Grounds in Paynesville, MN. For the weekend, we leave our busy schedules behind and gather together for fellowship, for relaxation, and for learning and worship.

This year, we will explore what it takes for individuals and groups to move from isolation to community. Looking at the Biblical depiction of immigration – what it means to be an immigrant and what it means to welcome people into community – and reflecting on our own experiences of being in both isolation and in community, we'll consider

what we can do as a community to truly open our hearts and doors.

We hope you will consider joining us for this wonderful weekend!

Your registration fee gives you:

- 2 nights lodging
- 5 meals (breakfast, lunch, and dinner on Saturday, and breakfast and lunch on Sunday)
- 3 hours of childcare
- 24/7 intergenerational opportunities

Lots of playmates for everyone!

2017 Winter Retreat Pricing

1 Adult Lakeview	\$125
2 Adults Lakeview	\$250
1 Adult Sunrise	\$190
2 Adults Sunrise	\$300
Youth (11-18)	\$95
Children (4-11)	\$80
Infant/Toddler (0-3)	Free

Lakeview: Twin beds, shared bathroom down the hall.

Sunrise: Two full sized beds, private bathroom in the room.

Please look to the left to see what your registration pays for. No refunds for people who leave early and/or eat less than 5 meals. The amount paid by partial attendees not used to cover the cost of this weekend will go into the camp scholarship fund.

Families in need are encouraged to ask for a scholarship (please speak with Jenia Strom, Paul Minehart, or Jason Emrick). If you would be willing to contribute to help others attend winter retreat, please indicate that amount below.

Total Amount Due: _____
Total Amount Paid: _____



Return registration form and check by January 15th to

Minnehaha United Methodist

3701 East 50th Street

Minneapolis, MN 55417

Phone: 612/721-6231

www.minnehaha.org



A New Chance



When I went off to college, eons ago, I decided it was a chance to start over. I was going to be far away from home, and I knew nobody at this new school. It was an opportunity to remake myself, to be someone new. And, in keeping with this new identity, I thought I would go by a new name. I would be Rebecca, not Becky. As you might guess, this didn't really pan out for me. I couldn't make the Rebecca thing stick for me, kept introducing myself as Becky, and then I found out that I was still the same person I had been, even in a new setting, far away from home. At the time, it was a little disappointing to find out that there was not some new, exotic person just waiting inside of me, but I find it comforting now. Comforting to know that my essential being carries across geography and experience. I love learning things no matter my setting. I find it difficult to pick up new languages whether I'm in my home town, at college far away, or visiting a friend in Italy. I don't like cooked peas no matter how they are fixed. Only raw, please. The difference on the cooked peas is that now I don't have to eat them just because my parents said so.

January 1 starts a new year. In many ways, it is arbitrary. January 1 is like any other day on the calendar. It's a Sunday, so we'll have worship. It's a holiday, but since it's also a Sunday, many of the things that would be closed will be closed anyway. We will be the same creations of God on January 1 that we were on December 31 and will be on January 2. But . . .

A new year is a time to take stock. What from the last year would you like to leave behind? What from your past do you want to be sure and keep? What would you like to add to your life? Some of you have had changing life events of moves, births, deaths, illnesses, trips that might cause you to take stock anyway. But for all of us, I encourage making some time for self-reflection as we approach a new year. And, as creations of God, maybe those questions should be more like, what things is God calling you to keep doing? Are there new places God is calling you to? You are always God's creation, but is there a new name that God is calling forth out of you? A new way God is calling you to be in the world? It doesn't have to all happen on January 1, but listen for the voice of God in this new year, and pray for the wisdom and strength to respond accordingly.

In joy,

Becky

Warren Russell Grubb was baptized 12/11





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1/17

